



P 29 · 48 PAGES, PROMPTED JOURNAL

A 'Who Am I Now' Journal

Forty-eight pages of prompted journaling for the mother who looks in the mirror and does not immediately recognize herself. Not a self-help book. Not a "find your old self" book. A book for the version of you who is here, building a new self, on a schedule no one warned you about.

Soothemade **Notes**

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

There is a version of postpartum writing that promises to help you “get yourself back.” This journal does not do that.

You are not going back. The version of you before the baby was real. The version of you now is also real. The work is not recovering an old self, it is meeting the new one, who is showing up in pieces, on her own schedule, often when the baby is finally asleep.

This is a journal for that meeting.

It is for any stretch of postpartum or post-postpartum where the language for who you are now has not arrived yet. Year one. Year three. The week your kid started school. The morning you found a pair of pants in the back of the closet that no longer fit a person you no longer are.

With care, Maya

This is a journaling tool, not therapy or medical advice. If you are in crisis or sustained low mood, please talk to a real provider. The numbers are at the back.

How to use this journal

- Forty-eight pages, undated. Start whenever.
- Read the prompts when you have ten quiet minutes. Not five. Not three. The journal does not work in three-minute bursts.
- Skip prompts that don't apply. There is no order.
- Some prompts will land hard. Sit on the floor. Take the time.
- Some prompts will feel like nothing today. Try them in three months. The same prompt asked twice, six months apart, will produce different answers.
- Bring it to therapy if you have one. The prompts are good conversation starters.

The starting page

A short page to fill in once.

DATE: _____

WHY I AM OPENING THIS JOURNAL TODAY (one sentence):

THE VERSION OF ME READING THIS, IN THREE WORDS:

ONE THING I AM AFRAID THIS JOURNAL MIGHT ASK

ONE THING I AM HOPING IT WILL HELP ME SEE

WHO, IF ANYONE, WILL READ THIS

- ☐ No one but me
- ☐ My partner, eventually
- ☐ My kid, when they are an adult
- ☐ Not sure yet

I AM WRITING IN THIS JOURNAL DURING:

- ☐ The first year postpartum
- ☐ Year 2-3
- ☐ A specific transition: _____
- ☐ A general "who am I now" stretch that doesn't have a name yet

What I miss

A page that gives permission to grieve.

Some things about the version of you before the baby are gone. Not just paused. Actually gone. Different shape, different scale, different rules.

Grieving them is allowed. Grieving does not mean you regret the baby. It means you are a person who notices what has changed.

Write a list. Long or short. Honest. Not for posting.

I MISS:

- ☐ The sleep
- ☐ The free time
- ☐ The body I had
- ☐ The wardrobe that fit
- ☐ The hobbies I had time for
- ☐ The friendships that have thinned
- ☐ The version of me who could leave the house with a wallet and a phone
- ☐ The version of me who did not check the baby breathing eight times a night
- ☐ The version of my partnership before the baby
- ☐ The Sundays
- ☐ The travel
- ☐ The career trajectory I had assumed I would have
- ☐ The version of myself I thought I would be at this age
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

ONE THING FROM THE LIST I WANT TO GRIEVE MORE

ONE THING I REALIZE I DO NOT ACTUALLY MISS,
EVEN THOUGH I'M SUPPOSED TO

What is new in me

A page that gives permission to claim.

Some things about you are new. Some you have noticed. Some you have not noticed yet because they have not had a name.

Write a list. Long or short. Honest. Not for posting.

NEW IN ME:

- ☐ A specific capability I did not know I had
- ☐ A specific tenderness, with the baby or with others
- ☐ A specific impatience that wasn't there before
- ☐ A way of being in my own skin that is new
- ☐ A clarity about who I will and will not stay close to
- ☐ A weight in my chest that does not always go away
- ☐ A specific kind of joy that does not show up in photos
- ☐ A new fear, named or unnamed
- ☐ A new boundary I have started to hold
- ☐ A new friendship
- ☐ A new ambition
- ☐ A new restlessness
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

ONE THING FROM THE LIST I'M PROUD OF

ONE THING FROM THE LIST I AM NOT SURE WHAT TO DO WITH

The twelve identity prompts

Twelve prompts. One per week if you want a pace. One per month if that is the pace.

There are no right answers. There are no required answers. You can write a paragraph or a sentence. You can write "I don't know" and come back.

Prompt 1

When did I last laugh in a way I recognized as my own?

(Not a polite laugh. Not a laugh-for-the-baby laugh. The laugh that was you, in a way you'd known yourself before. Where? Why?)

Prompt 2

What is one thing I want my child to never have to defend about themselves?

(The thing about you, growing up, that you had to spend years explaining or apologizing for. Write it down. Then write what you are doing, this week, to make sure they don't have to.)

Prompt 3

What part of my mother (or main caregiver) do I want to keep?

(Specific. Not "her kindness." Her exact way of doing one thing. The way she sat on the edge of the bed at night. The way she said hello to the dog.)

Prompt 4

What part of my mother (or main caregiver) do I want to leave behind?

(Same specificity. Not "her anger." The exact thing. The shape of her silence at the dinner table. The phrase she used that I still flinch from.)

Prompt 5

If I could give my pre-baby self one piece of information, what would it be?

(Not "it gets easier." Specific. About something the pre-baby version of me genuinely did not know.)

Prompt 6

Who is the friend I have lost track of, who I miss more than I have admitted?

(Write their name. Write down what stopped the friendship. Write whether you would text them today.)

Prompt 7

What is one place I haven't been to in a long time that I want to go again?

(Could be a literal place. Could be a state of mind. A bar. A library. The kind of conversation. The kind of music.)

Prompt 8

If I were 80 years old, looking back at the version of me right now, what would I tell her?

(Be the 80-year-old. Talk to the current you. Plain language. No clichés.)

Prompt 9

What is the smallest thing about my body that I have made peace with?

(Specific. A scar. A line. A change. Not "my whole body." One small specific thing.)

Prompt 10

What is the thing I do for myself that no one knows about?

(The way you put the coffee down before the first sip. The book on the kitchen counter you read three lines of every morning. The song you sing in the shower. Small things count.)

Prompt 11

What is a question I keep asking myself that I have not yet answered?

(Could be about the job. The marriage. The number of kids. The where-to-live. Write the question, not the answer.)

Prompt 12

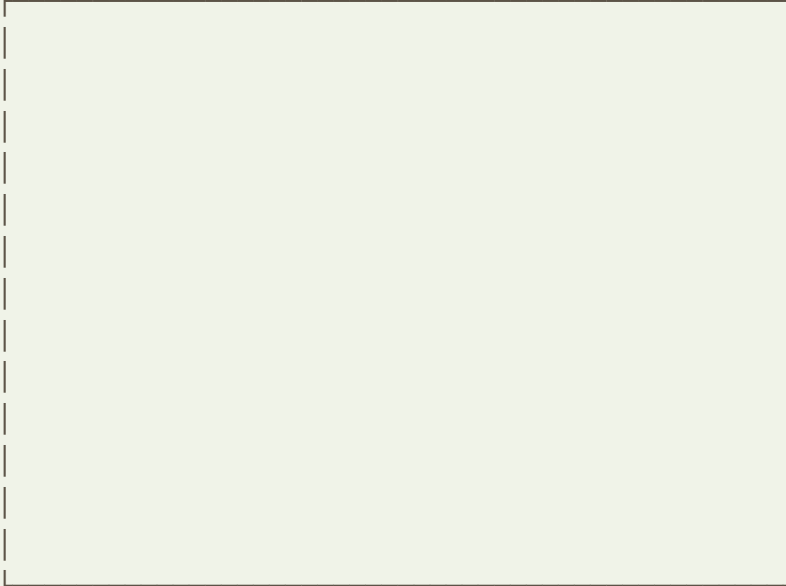
Who am I now?

(In one paragraph. Or one sentence. Or one word.)

The monthly drawing-of-myself page

A page repeated twelve times. Not literal. Symbol, color, shape, scribble.

MONTH _____ / YEAR _____



THIS MONTH'S DRAWING, IN ONE SENTENCE

WHAT I WANT THE NEXT MONTH'S DRAWING TO LOOK MORE LIKE

The friendship page

A page about who has stayed and who has thinned.

THE FRIENDSHIP MAP, RIGHT NOW

PEOPLE WHO HAVE STAYED

1. _____ (since: _____)

2. _____

3. _____

PEOPLE WHO HAVE THINNED

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

PEOPLE WHO ARE NEW (since the baby, or since the change)

1. _____

2. _____

A FRIENDSHIP I HAVE NEGLECTED THAT I WANT BACK

A FRIENDSHIP I HAVE OUTGROWN AND IT IS OKAY

ONE PERSON I COULD TEXT TODAY, AND WON'T REGRET IT

The body page

Without the wellness industry's vocabulary. Just yours.

THE BODY, IN MY OWN WORDS

THE PARTS THAT FEEL FAMILIAR

THE PARTS THAT FEEL NEW

THE PARTS THAT FEEL LIKE THEY BELONG TO SOMEONE ELSE

WHAT IT WANTS RIGHT NOW (in one sentence)

WHAT IT IS NOT GETTING RIGHT NOW (in one sentence)

A WORD THAT IS NOT MINE THAT I AM NO LONGER WILLING
TO USE ABOUT MY BODY

(Examples that came up for other readers: "bounce back",
"snap back", "let yourself go", "post-baby". Yours
might be different.)

A WORD I WANT TO USE INSTEAD

The work page

Whether that's the same thing or a new thing or both.

THE WORK

WHAT I USED TO DO

WHAT I DO NOW

- ☐ The same job, in a different way
- ☐ A different job entirely
- ☐ Not yet working / on leave
- ☐ Unpaid work, full-time (childcare, household)
- ☐ Self-employed / on my own thing
- ☐ Still figuring it out

WHAT IS HARDER ABOUT THE WORK NOW

WHAT IS UNEXPECTEDLY EASIER

WHAT I WOULD DO IF MONEY DIDN'T MATTER

WHAT I WANT FROM THE NEXT 5 YEARS OF WORK

The annual ritual

A page to fill in once a year, on a date that matters to you. The same questions. Year over year, the answers shift.

Print or copy. Use it on:

- The baby's birthday (or due date if you'd rather)
- Your birthday
- A specific seasonal anchor (the first day of school, the longest night, your wedding anniversary, your name day)

- A made-up date that matters to no one but you

YEAR ____ / DATE _____

WHO I AM, THIS YEAR, IN A FEW SENTENCES

THREE WORDS FOR THIS YEAR

ONE THING I WAS WRONG ABOUT, LOOKING BACK

ONE THING I WAS RIGHT ABOUT

WHAT IS BIGGER IN ME THAN A YEAR AGO

WHAT IS SMALLER IN ME THAN A YEAR AGO

WHAT I WANT FOR NEXT YEAR'S VERSION OF THIS PAGE

If you write on this page for ten years, that becomes one of the best things you have ever written.

The five-year letter

A letter to the version of you who will be reading this in five years. To be opened then.

DEAR _____ , IN FIVE YEARS:

Today is _____.

The thing I want you to remember about who I am right now,
that you might forget:

A thing I am afraid of, that I want you to tell me about
how it turned out:

A small joy that is happening right now, that I want
you to picture:

A question I want you to answer for me, five years from
now:

I love you. I am you. I am proud of us.

(your name, today's date)

Seal it in an envelope. Write "open in five years" on the outside. Stick it in the journal. Or in a drawer. Or in the back of a book you trust.

The “I don’t know” page

A page that is okay to write nothing on.

Some questions don’t have answers yet. Some pages do not get filled.

Sitting with the not-knowing is also the work. Not every page of who-you-are-now resolves into a sentence.

If you got to this page and have written nothing in months, that is allowed. The journal will be here. You will come back to it, or you will not, and either is part of what becoming-someone-new looks like.

Soothemade.

When the journal isn't enough

A short page. Honest.

A journal helps you see your own pattern. It does not, by itself, treat depression, anxiety, intrusive thoughts, or other postpartum mood concerns.

If, as you write in this journal, you notice:

- A sustained low mood that doesn't lift
- Thoughts about hurting yourself
- Thoughts about hurting the baby
- A sustained inability to feel anything for the baby
- A sustained inability to feel anything at all
- Disconnection from reality
- Increasing isolation that feels involuntary

Please talk to a real provider. The journal is for noticing. The treatment is for treating.

US MATERNAL MENTAL HEALTH HOTLINE

1-833-852-6262 (24/7, free, confidential, parent-specific)

US SUICIDE & CRISIS LIFELINE

988 (call or text, 24/7)

POSTPARTUM SUPPORT INTERNATIONAL

1-800-944-4773

A THERAPIST (if you have one)

Name: _____ Number: _____



From Soothemade Notes, a small apothecary of printables, planners, and cards for the unphotographed parts of new parenthood. Made slowly, in plain language.



Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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